

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

(This is a two-page report. Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.)

2000-54

7-0(A)

Each table cell will automatically enlarge as you type!

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CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name): LESSER BLACK-BACKED GULL		(Scientific Name) <i>Larus fuscus</i>
Date(s) of occurrence: 12 March 2000		
Number of birds seen: One of this age class	Sex: Unknown	Plumage: Third-Basic
Exact Location: Lake Loveland		
County: Larimer	Nearest town: Loveland	Elevation: 5005 msl
Length of observation: Observed during a roughly 15-minute period off and on.	Time(s) of observation: Approximately 5:45 MST	
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Tony Leukering		
Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s):		
Light Conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s); position: Sunset, partly cloudy. Facing east.		
Optical equipment used: 8 x 40 Binoculars, 32X Bushnell Spotting Scope		
Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): Difficult to judge, perhaps 250 yards		
Was bird(s) photographed? No	If so, have you submitted photos?	
Who took the photographs?		
Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Open water lake		
Describe the bird's behavior (flying, feeding, habits, behaviors used in identifying the Species or in supporting the identification): Observed while swimming		
Describe the bird in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include the overall size and shape and how you placed the bird in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird(s). Describe other important details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches or copy field notes):		
A minimum of four (if not five) Lesser Black-backed Gulls of all age-classes were observed at Lake Loveland on the same date. Documentations for all Lesser Black-backed Gulls have also been submitted to the committee. This report documents the occurrence of a third-winter Lesser Black-backed Gull.		
Overall Size: As with other Lesser Black-backed Gull identifications submitted from this site, the subject bird was much smaller than nearby first-winter Great Black-backed Gull and appeared even slightly smaller than Herring Gulls, seemingly similar in size as California Gulls. Overall shape was slender and attenuated due to a long wing-tip extension and relatively slim bill.		
Bill: The bill appeared relatively thin, long, and with a slight gonydeal angle. Through the scope, it appeared that the bill was two-toned with a lighter basal half and blackish distal half. This differed markedly with the large, thick, bulbous-tipped bill of a Great Black-backed and seemed even less massive than adjacent Herring Gulls.		
Head and Neck: Similar to that of a full adult except for possibly slightly lesser degrees of brown streaking. This streaking was quite heavy throughout the crown, nape and sides of the neck.		
Upperparts: The upperparts looked full adult-like expressing a very dark gray mantle and wings that was noticeably darker than that of nearby California Gulls. The scapulars and coverts were also the same shade of dark gray, separating it from the browner scapulars and coverts typically seen on a second-year bird. The tertials appeared the same shade of dark gray (except for the presence of white fringes).		
Underparts: Mostly white but still retained some diffuse, brownish streaking along the upper flanks.		
Tail: Tail coloration was not apparent.		
Wingtips: The primary tips appeared black but seemed to display some small white mirrors to the terminal tips of the primaries.		
Leg Color: Though relatively diagnostic in separation with Great Black-backed Gull, I could not observe the color of the legs since the bird was swimming.		
Eye Color: Not discernible.		
Describe bird's call or song: None noted		

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

Great Black-backed Gull: The subject bird was significantly smaller (one-third smaller) than Great Black-backed Gull with a much thinner and smaller bill. Besides being considerably larger in overall size and shape (more bulky), second-year Great Black-backs would have a noticeably whiter head and body. Second-year Great Black-backs have a mostly white head, breast, and belly but would display small amounts of spotting or diffuse streaking along the lower portions of the sides and nape of the neck and also along the flanks. The mantle and upperwings of second-year Great Black-backs would also be a much lighter shade than second-year Lessers and would be lighter gray/brown with scattered black mantle feathers emerging. A first-winter Great black-backed Gull was also present at this locale and was compared directly with this and other Lesser Black-backed Gulls.

Herring Gull: Typical first winter Herring Gulls (which were also present for direct comparison) are usually smaller than Lesser Black-backed Gulls (though some small Herring's can overlap in size) and would be extensively more mud-brown throughout. The head, mantle, wings, and underparts would be much browner and would lack the mostly white (but streaked head, dark gray mantle, and whitish underparts of a Lesser Black-backed.

California Gull: Though somewhat similar in size to California Gulls, Lesser Black-backed Gulls differ in morphology and plumage by having rather thicker mandibles and a slightly thicker build. The bill of a second-winter California Gull is a greenish-blue shade overall with a thin dark subterminal band, quite unlike the mostly dark bill (with pinkish basal lower mandible) of a second-winter Lesser Black-backed Gull. The head, neck, and flanks of a second-winter California Gull would be much heavier streaked with brown than a Lesser. Mantle color of a California would also be lighter in shade than the very dark gray plumage of a Lesser.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? Have observed all age-classes of numerous other Lesser Black-backed Gulls in Colorado, Wisconsin, Minnesota, Texas, Florida, Pennsylvania, New Jersey, and in Europe.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None

This report is from notes made during or after XX observation or later from memory

Date of written report:

Reporting observer: Larry Semo

Signature:



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